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Overview: 2 Samuel

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Overview: 2 Samuel

David's reign is marked by incredible success, terrible failure, and God's promise.

The book of 2 Samuel continues to show us the virtue of humility, the destructiveness of pride, and the faithfulness of God's promise. We see David succeed and fail, and we see God's promise for a future king at the beginning and end of the story.

The Rise and Fall of David

After the death of Saul, David unifies the twelve tribes as their king. In his new capital of Jerusalem, David desires to build God a house. Instead, God promises to build David an eternal house through a king from his lineage. This is a key moment in the book of 2 Samuel and in the Hebrew Scriptures that point us toward a messianic king who will come to fulfill the promise given to David and Abraham to bless all nations.

However, we soon discover that David is not that king. After failing spectacularly, the kingdom slowly unravels. The final chapters of 2 Samuel highlight moments of David's weakness, showing us his own failure as similar to Saul's, while promising another king who will come to fulfill God's good purposes.